CHAPTER ONE

INTELLIGENCE

On Research and Intelligence Assessment

The Mossad Division Head's Forum (Rasha) is the equivalent of the IDF's General Staff. In addition to its weekly meetings for the purposes of reporting and decision-making, the Mossad director convenes Rasha at his discretion for nonroutine purposes. Not long after I took office in April 1989, I convened the group to bid farewell to those members who were retiring and to welcome the new members. I believe that some of the things that I said during that meeting in 1989 deserve to be repeated today.

The people who were present at that meeting reflected the history of the Mossad, its generational changes and its continuity. I was the first Mossad director who did not belong to the generation that had fought in the War of Independence, but during the meeting I made a point of emphasizing that despite the changes the Mossad had undergone since its establishment—in its missions, arenas of action, tools and capabilities, priorities, and scale—one thing that never changed and that must never change was what I called the "human spirit." It was especially important for me to say this in light of the processes that were affecting Israeli society—the culture of materialism, the disintegration of values, and the dissipation of Zionism.

I thought it appropriate to use that event, as I began my term as director of the Mossad, to emphasize my "credo" regarding the preservation of secrecy in our organization. Even then, in 1989, this was a serious challenge in light of the fact that Israeli society was deeply entrenched in the era of modern communication, in which the principle of "the public's right to